

1-2-3 Capacity-Building Action Plan & 45-Day Launch Program

Ryan, you offer a valuable service that solves direct, immediate problems for older adults and less tech-focused individuals in Northwestern Ontario. You provide the patient, in-home guidance that telecom retailers cannot. To grow this while working a full-time job, the business must move from informal, one-off assistance to a structured, highly credible service that you can operate independently. This is the blueprint.

CURRENT SERVICE REALITY

You currently offer a robust suite of tech interventions:

(A) Tech Support & Guidance

From email account creation to basic Q&A, familiarizing users with their technology.

(B) Set-Up & Data Transfers

Old-to-new device setups, cross-OS migrations, and peripheral configuration.

(C) Cleaning & Optimization

Malicious ad removal, OS updating, and efficiency tools.

(D) Purchasing & Selling

Sourcing safe, reliable stock to act as transfer/demo pieces and retail inventory.

(E) CAPS (Clerical & Admin Support)

Leveraging writing skills to assist seniors with pension documentation and form submissions.

THE PROBLEM & RECOMMENDED SHIFT

The Problem: A flat \$60/hour rate untethered from a defined outcome feels open-ended and expensive to new customers. Operating without a visible, professional digital footprint makes people question if the business is a scam. Furthermore, relying entirely on one-off hourly calls makes it impossible to efficiently schedule around your full-time job.

The Shift: Service-first positioning. Lead with fixed-outcome packages while retaining hourly billing only where a package is not practical. A professional, founder-visible presence and formal sales materials for community groups will reduce skepticism and make the service easier to understand, book, and refer.

Desired Outcomes @ The 1–2–3 Pathway

1. Authenticity & Trust

Erase hesitation by deploying a professional digital presence, verified testimonials, and clear intake systems. No one should ever wonder if Gizmos and Gadgets is a scam.

2. Strategic Pricing

Move away from hourly billing. Deploy structured service packages that customers immediately understand and value.

3. Community Clinic Reach

Formalize your pop-up model to efficiently service community groups (e.g., Happy-Go-Lucky Seniors) in scheduled batches.

4. Time Management

Optimize your scheduling and intake so this business complements, rather than conflicts with, your full-time job.

THE 1–2–3 PATHWAY

01 — Starter Company Plus (SCP)

Engage in business planning and training. This program offers potential grant funding of up to \$5,000 for eligible launch costs.

02 — Secure an Approved Matching-Fund Partner

Use the completed SCP plan and proposed \$5,000 contribution to seek a separate 50% cost-share approval. Current possibilities require direct confirmation:

- **NOIC Next Level:** closest marketing-consulting fit, but currently closed and subject to business-model eligibility.
- **NOIC BBAA:** limited funding consultations are available, but only for substantive AI adoption—not a basic website launch.
- **NOHFC Invest North — Launch:** applications are available, but its full-time-owner, new-business, own-contribution, marketing-cap, and consulting-cost rules make this scope a weak fit.
- **Regional alternatives:** ask Northwest Business Centre, NOIC, and Sioux Lookout Innovation Centre to identify an open, compatible \$5,000 stream.

Gate: obtain written confirmation that SCP funds can be stacked and accepted as match before committing project costs.

Before contracting: Confirm eligibility, stacking, treatment of SCP funds, vendor rules, project dates, eligible costs, taxes, payment timing, and reimbursement. If no compatible grant is approved, Ryan may finance the project another way or reduce the scope.

03 — The 45-Day Launch Project

A structured, finite launch engagement executed by Headwaters to build your professional infrastructure. The project may proceed through approved matched funding or through another financing route chosen by Ryan.

Explicit Funding Arithmetic

The launch project is sized at \$10,000. The intended illustration is two approved \$5,000 contributions—not a confirmed grant award.

Headwaters Professional Services	\$7,500
Reserved for Approved Direct Launch Expenses	\$2,500
Total Project Budget	\$10,000

Possible Matched Funding Illustration:

- Up to \$5,000 from Starter Company Plus, if awarded and permitted as match.
- Up to \$5,000 from a separate 50% cost-share program, if Ryan and the project qualify.

NOHFC Invest North — Launch

Status: Applications are available, but this project is not a strong fit as currently scoped.

- The owner is expected to work in the new business full-time.
- A new business is generally one operating for six months or less.
- Project, consulting, and administration costs are listed as ineligible.
- Marketing is capped, and the applicant must provide at least 15% from their own resources.

Northwestern Ontario Innovation Centre

Next Level: The closest 50% program for marketing consulting is currently closed and also excludes part-time businesses, retailers, resellers, and consultants.

BBAA: Limited funding is open for genuine AI-adoption projects at 50% cost-share. A basic website and marketing launch would not qualify on their own.

The 45-Day Launch Project Scope

A focused, finite sprint to build the operational and marketing infrastructure required for Gizmos and Gadgets Hub to run independently and profitably.

HEADWATERS QUOTE: \$7,500

Positioning & Pricing Framework

Converting your \$60/hour model into distinct, outcome-based service packages (e.g., The Setup, The Clean, The Transfer). We define exactly what is included, what it costs, and how long it takes.

Credibility System

Creation of a unified brand identity—wordmarks, typography, color palettes, and messaging guidelines—designed to instantly project institutional trust and eliminate "scam" hesitations.

Digital Web Presence

A fully functional, mobile-optimized website outlining your packages, your story, your service area, and verified client testimonials.

Booking, Intake & Follow-up

Deployment of an automated workflow to handle customer requests, triage needs before the appointment, and follow up afterward, reducing your administrative burden.

Organization Clinic Sales Kit

A professional pitch deck and physical leave-behinds designed specifically for selling pop-up clinic days to groups like the Dryden Go-Getters or Vermilion Bay seniors clubs.

45-Day Campaign Materials

Initial marketing collateral (flyers, localized social graphics, community board postings) to announce the formalized service.

Launch Support, Analytics & Handoff

Final testing of all systems, measuring initial engagement, and a full handoff session ensuring you can operate every tool without ongoing consultant fees.

Headwaters is a finite launch provider, not your ongoing manager. Note that future exposure, inclusion in a Headwaters case study, references, and appropriate introductions represent additional mutual value, and are not a substitute for the \$7,500 professional services fee.

Exclusions, Process & Responsibilities

PROJECT EXCLUSIONS

To ensure we stay on budget and timeline, the following are strictly excluded from the \$7,500 scope:

- Purchasing of device inventory.
- Paid advertising spend (beyond the reserved \$2,500 direct budget).
- Grant writing (unless separately scoped).
- Ongoing social media management or content creation post-launch.
- Ongoing business coaching or legal/accounting advice.
- Unlimited revisions.

RYAN'S RESPONSIBILITIES

- Timely attendance at the 5 scheduled meetings.
- Providing prompt, consolidated feedback at review gates.
- Supplying core content inputs (your story, available photos, existing client references).
- Securing written funding confirmations prior to kickoff.

SUCCESS MEASURES

- At least 1 community-clinic proposal delivered using the new sales kit.
- New leads are offered clear fixed-price packages where appropriate.
- Founder identity, service boundaries, contact details, and trust signals are publicly visible.
- All workflows fully handed over and operable by Ryan.

WORKING PARAMETERS

Five-Meeting Limit

To respect your full-time work schedule and maintain our 45-day velocity, our engagement is capped at 5 structured, high-impact meetings (Kickoff, Brand Review, Web Review, Sales Kit Review, Final Handoff).

Consolidated Feedback

Instead of endless email threads, all project feedback is batched and consolidated at designated review gates.

HEADWATERS RESPONSIBILITIES

- On-time delivery of all scoped digital and physical assets.
- Transparent communication regarding project status.
- Adherence to the 45-day timeline constraint.
- Ensuring all systems are fully handed over for independent operation.

MILESTONES & PAYMENTS

Proposed Headwaters payments: \$2,250 at kickoff, \$3,000 at build approval, and \$2,250 at final handoff. Timing may be adjusted to approved funder rules. The final contract will confirm taxes and keep all costs within the approved project budget.

Risks & Safeguards

Operating a tech support business in a small region carries specific risks. We build these safeguards into your operational plan from day one:

1. The Bell Conflict

Risk: Perception of conflict of interest with your employer.

Safeguard: Strict adherence to positioning Gizmos and Gadgets as an in-home mobile support and clinic service, entirely distinct from telecom retail sales.

2. Inventory Holding

Risk: Tying up vital cash flow in depreciating tech hardware.

Safeguard: Treating devices strictly as transfer/demo pieces rather than adopting a primary retail holding model. Avoid taking on debt to buy inventory.

3. Privacy & Data

Risk: Mishandling sensitive information belonging to vulnerable elderly clients.

Safeguard: Establishing clear, written data-handling protocols and waivers that protect both the client and your business.

4. CAPS (Clerical Support) Boundaries

Risk: Accidentally assuming legal or financial liability when helping with pensions.

Safeguard: Clear boundary documentation proving you act strictly as an administrative assistant, not an authorized representative.

5. Used Devices

Risk: Acquiring stolen, carrier-blocked, locked, or poor-condition hardware.

Safeguard: Use documented IMEI/blacklist, activation-lock, battery, condition, data-erasure, return, and warranty checks before accepting or selling a device.

ACCEPTANCE & NEXT STEPS

- Review this capacity-building plan in its entirety.
- Present this document to Starter Company Plus and your matching funding partner.
- Confirm stacking, matching, and eligible-cost rules in writing.
- Once funding is approved, Headwaters will issue a formal contract and schedule our Kickoff Meeting.

Disclaimer: This document is a non-binding capacity-building action plan and preliminary quote. All funding arithmetic, potential grant matches, and project budgets are illustrative and must be explicitly confirmed by the respective funding agencies (Starter Company Plus, NOHFC, Northwest Business Centre, Sioux Lookout Innovation Centre, etc.) before any financial commitments are made. Headwaters Development Services assumes no liability for grant application outcomes or funder decisions.